

**April 28, 2021
4:00 to 5:30PM
Curriculum Subcommittee Meeting - Via Zoom
Notes**

4:03 Paulette Van der Kloot read introduction

Attendees:

Paulette Van der Kloot, Jenny Graham, Present

Mea Mustone absent; Paul Ruseau sitting in for Mea Mustone

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Peter Cushing, Joan Bowen, Suzanne Galusi, Haley Rello (Music), Bernadette Ricciardelli, Rocco Cieri, S. Fee (Art), Suzi Weiss, Lisa Evangelista

Science presentation: Rocco Cieri, Director of Science

Presenting Science overview pre-pandemic with adjustments made due to the pandemic

[Sharing Slide Deck](#)

State Frameworks

-Based on work devised by Achieve Inc. in 2013, approved by the state in 2016 then adopted by Medford.

- Content varies by grade but Science and Tech practices are consistent for each grade
- Changes:

- 1.Integration of science and engineering practices
 2. Grade by grade standards K-8 rather than grade bands (Specific by grade)
 3. Specific subjects at high school level
- More design based thinking - application of science to engineering context
4. Include technology/engineering as its own discipline

- Earth Space/Physical Science/Life Science/Technology & Engineering (unique to Mass.)

- Engineering lab CTE at MHS/MVTHS

Tools completely updated. Unique program at the high school level. Hands on learning meeting the expectations of the state in that area.

- MCAS Science & Technology/Engineering

Grades 5, 8 and HS

Grade 5 and 8 integrate all science domains

HS: counts towards competency for HS. Moved to biology as 9th grade course. All

MHS/MVTHS take Bio class and MCAS in grade 9.

- Link to source syllabi in presentation

- AP Physics C (Calculus based); equal to 2 semesters of college credit

Environmental Science is an honors level but students can take the AP exam.

Medford Curriculum and Instruction

At k--8 level all resources are revamped. Third year of Foss Grade 3 -5. Stem scopes. Program digitized for remote access this year. As seamless as one would hope. Integrated into Google Classroom but has its own platform. Pandemic has restricted access to hands on work. Outlook for Stemscopes is great going towards in person learning. Have all materials in place.

The Sequence has changed in High School.

Gr. 9: Bio

Gr. 10: Chem

Grade 11 and 12: electives

Realigned beginning at grade 9 to make it match for MVTHS and MHS students.

Computer science/Biotech/Engineering CTE can count as a STE elective (third year of Science)

Foss, Grades K-5: only year 2 of adoption

Cost was \$285K.

Will need consumables/ living organisms in next year's budget cycle (not this year).

Emphasis on ecological responsibility and conservation saves on purchase of consumables

Learning walks paused due to pandemic.

Use of benchmarks and assessments - work in progress

STEM Scopes Grade 6-8: First year of use

Total cost: \$60K Ongoing costs: \$8000 year in consumables/\$10K subscription for online access

Began professional development this year (two full sessions). Very intuitive program. Beneficial for enrichment and scaffolding. Teachers have integrated it into Google Suite tools.

High School:

Biology: copyright 2001: we need to consider adopting a new program. Pearson 2021 Bio (miller and levine) approximately \$47,700 for textbooks and 6 year digital license. I recommend adoption in this meeting. Vendor gave us a free year this year because we were unable to complete the pilot in 2020. Satisfied with how it is going this year. They have offered a smaller slimmer book for free; Biology: the Core. Very beneficial to EL and Special Ed. populations. Less text.

Chemistry: Old. Copyright 1997. Review underway. Savas/Pearson has provided us with softcover books. There is a consumable book. Many vendors are stepping away from hard cover text books and offering workbooks instead.

AP courses need new textbooks: Physics, Chem, Anatomy/Physiology.

New electives committee will start next year. Promotion of co-teaching model.

Equity in science

Fully compliant with office of civil rights regulations

Next steps

Emphasis on hands-on learning and use of technology.

Questions:

Paul Ruseau: I am curious as to what is included in computer science?

Rocco Cieri: There are courses within that umbrella. Courses can count as Math or Science.

Jenny Graham: I remember when K-5 curriculum was happening, it was discussed that Engineering was not a strength of Foss?

Rocco Cieri: Foss is working on curricula aligning to each unit that serves this task. There will be an engineering/design challenge that will go with each unit. We will not have to redo some units because Foss is looking at it. Digital focus became a priority due to the pandemic.

Jenny Graham: In terms of Medford filling the gap, what is the time frame?

Rocco Cieri: Next year we will use what Foss has developed and fill in the gaps in the following year.

Jenny Graham: It is important to fill that for FY 23. It should go in the catalog as such. Being creative with consumables: nothing to do with financial issues. More with preservation of organisms. We need to find the correct ecological imprint.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I am surprised about the low demand for AP Environmental Science.

Rocco Cieri: Guidance counselors and teachers inform us.

Paulette Van der Kloot: How will a student know it is a potential course?

Rocco Cieri: Ms. Feitor will prepare them for the AP test if they are interested in it. Maybe we can roll it into the committee for elective courses.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Clear that there are significant text book needs.

Jenny Graham: I will send Rocco questions via email.

Fine Arts Presentation: Bernadette Ricciardelli Director of Curriculum and Instruction

Sharing presentation [link](#)

MA Arts curriculum frameworks adopted in 2019

Lead teachers began work to integrate into Medford's curriculum this year

Creating/presenting/responding/connecting: improvement on 1999 framework

Emphasis on social/emotional learning

Focus on cultural proficiency

Focus on meeting the needs of all learners

Both teams are working on presenting the essential questions to correlate to the new standards.

This work will continue for the next 6 months. By mid to late fall of 2021, it will be complete.

MUSIC

Elementary Music:

No signing this year due to COVID. Limited movement. We brought into the district a program that would work with remote instruction. Quaver Music added for K-5. Great music, culturally attentive. Recommendation is to continue with this program.

- Percussion: grades K-5
- Recorder: grade 3
- Strings: grades 4 and 5
- Band: starts in grade 5

Ability to engage in a lot of instrument work this year was limited due to health concerns of sharing instruments. Intent is to enhance what we have done in the past.

Middle School Music

Grades 7 and 8: Guitar playing introduced

We are recommending purchase of additional guitars and ukuleles.

Band, chorus and orchestra available to grades 6,7,8.

High School Music

Adaptive Music

Our music teacher is Special Ed. Licensed

Guitar one and two for high school

Band, Chorus, Music Technology, Percussion, Orchestra and Theater (open to grades 9 - 12)

Had to pull back a lot this year due to safety concerns.

Fine Arts Curriculum

K-5

Creating/presenting/responding/connecting

Art History

Communicating about art

Sharing of materials was a safety concern. There was a cleaning protocol between classes.

Middle school Art (Suzanne Fee is here)

- Principles of design and elements of art at each grade level

Tweaks to previous program. Not anticipating major changes.

High School Level

Ceramics, AP Studio Art, Art and Ideas, Design, Sculpture, etc.

PD 2021-2022

Quaver Music, Art of Education University: Pro Learning

Music Curriculum Review and Art Curriculum Review: Committees reviewing the new frameworks

Culturally Responsive Teaching Through the Arts (Lesley U)

Needs for 2021/2022 (approximately \$40K)

- Art display cases: art needs to be celebrated (10K)
- Art of Education: Flex Curriculum and Pro-Learning (7K)
- Quaver: (7K)
- Instruments: Ukuleles and guitars (7K)
- Sound systems all schools (6K)
- Amps/Microphones (2K)
- Bases: (1K)

Comments/Questions

Paulette Van der Kloot; typically 5th graders start with violin. What ability did we have this year? What is the impact on future orchestra programs?

Bernadette Ricciardelli we have a plan to reach out to get them back on track.

Haley Rello: No 4th grade strings or 5th grade band this year. Department of instrumental teachers doing a video and outreach to fill the gaps and recruit students for middle school programs.

Bernadette Ricciardelli I will check the DESE site to see if the restrictions have been lifted.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Are there instruments set aside for students who cannot afford it? I would love for you to look at that question so that we don't lose talented musicians who cannot afford to rent an instrument.

Bernadette Ricciardelli Quaver has the ability to give students their own accounts. Most appropriate for K-5 even though it is available for K-8. Charge is for school.

Jenny Graham: have we asked the students if they like Quaver?

Bernadette Ricciardelli Not yet. My observation is the kids enjoy the music and the lessons. I can reach out and try to construct a survey based on age level to see how they like it. We used it a lot this year because of remote instruction but it is a supplement to the regular curriculum.

Jenny Graham: The feedback is that I haven't gotten as many complaints this year. Music should be a topic they look forward to. Lot of untapped opportunities. Around the rental program, do we have the same rules in place for music rentals as we do for athletic fees (free rentals for free and reduced lunch).

Haley Rello: for 4th grade, we rent them to students for \$25. Kids can fill out a waiver. 5th graders we offer multiple rental options. David French Music is our outsource for Middle School and above (there is no program there for free and reduced lunch). We do get donations and I fix them up for students who need them. There is not a program in place but we do everything we can to make it happen.

Jenny Graham: I have seen a good amount of chatter about school committees creating parity for fees - athletic and music.

Paulette Van der Kloot; My personal experience was Mr. Zigne took care of cases as they came up.

Thank you everyone for being here.

Motion to adjourn: Paulette Van der Kloot/Jenny Graham Yes 5:30